COS-FIELD ISA

2023-2024 Program Review

Submitted By:

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1. Program Description:

Since 2012, the College of the Siskiyous has maintained a partnership with Farmworker Institute for Education and Leadership Development (FIELD) through an Instructional Service Agreement (ISA). The annual agreement entered is that FIELD provides instructional and other services for non-credit English as a Second Language (ESL) courses and potentially other non-credit courses and COS provides administrative and academic supervision of instruction carried out by FIELD employees, record keeping, and other administrative services pertaining to course offerings. The regulations pertaining to ISAs are contained in California Education Code sections 78015, 84752 and California Code of Regulations, title 5, sections 51006, 53410, 55002, 55003, 55005, 55300, 58050, 58051(c)–(g), 58051.5, 58055, 58056, 58058(b), 58102-58106, 58108

Founded by Cesar Chavez in 1978, FIELD promotes economic and social prosperity for underserved communities through education, workforce training, and economic development. FIELD offers a wide range of free services “through adult education, job training, career development – all of which leads to self-confidence, self-sufficiency, and opportunities to break generational barriers,” an October 2024 FIELD board member newsletter stated. ”We are proud that we can help lift up our community and serve them in a multitude of ways.” FIELD’s work and mission is consistent with the College’s mission to transform students’ lives through lifelong learning and success and helps broaden the socio-economic strata it serves by offering ESL classes to significantly underserved populations.

COS faculty develop curriculum for the courses. The College collects apportionment on all the classes offered by FIELD and reimburses FIELD throughout the year based on a mutually agreed upon rate per hour of instruction. Since 2020, apportionment from these classes has not been collected due to the California Community College Chancellor’s Office “hold harmless “ rule in which colleges received a funding baseline. This regulation was enacted to mitigate economic impacts from the pandemic.

The FIELD Director — a College employee — serves as the liaison between the College and FIELD and does not oversee a specific academic program, rather oversees programming related to the FIELD relationship.

The College’s partnership with FIELD enables the college to serve a significantly more diverse student population and to reach and underserved population. FIELD delivers its classes to economically disadvantaged adults over the age of 18 who are primarily Latino. In 2023-2024, the College’s partnership with FIELD served more students than any other program at the College.

Program Objectives

The 3-course ESL sequence is designed to take students from survival level English skills to high intermediate English proficiency. Classes prepare students for a variety of vocational or career fields and/or for transition into credit-bearing college courses. Students who complete all 3 ESL courses and demonstrate mastery of learning outcomes, earn a Certificate of Completion.

The Certificate of Completion provides “communicative English skills in speaking, listening, reading, and writing to speakers of other languages.” The Certificate of Completion is designed to meet the needs of diverse language learners and to provide opportunity for students to learn at their own pace through class repeatability.

New Course Modality -- Online ESL Classes:

The 2023-2024 academic year marked a new shift in ESL offerings with online ESL classes offered through FIELD the entire year. Previously, there was one session of online ESL held in April 2022. All online classes are 6 weeks.

Online ESL launched in April 2022

While face-to-face ESL classes were 90 hours in duration, online ESL classes are 132 hours to account for additional instructor contact hours and student work outside of class.

ESL 0561: ESL Level 1 (0 units, 132 total hours: 90 instruction hours, 12 instructor contact hours, 30 out of class hours)

ESL 0562: ESL Level 2 (0 units,132 total hours: 90 instruction hours, 12 instructor contact hours, 30 out of class hours)

ESL 0563: ESL Level 3 (0 units, 132 total hours: 90 instruction hours, 12 instructor contact hours, 30 out of class hours)

These online classes came with new requirements for FIELD regarding student support and teaching requirements for instructors. These classes are offered through Canvas and offered at 3 different levels through 3 different course shells.

The College requires FIELD to have Student Support Centers to support ESL students and provide technological access required for online classes. Student Support Centers are a place students go to get help with technological support provided by teaching assistants. With the understanding that most FIELD students have limited computer skills, teaching assistants can help with such tasks as logging into class. There are 10-15 laptops in each center. Most of the centers are at existing FIELD locations where its adult charter high school, EPIC, is based.

Instructors provide support via email and Zoom. The ESL instructor initially sends out a welcome email to the student with all necessary information including Canvas login. If the student has difficulties logging in or has questions the ESL instructor tries to help and explain how to log in and navigate through the platform. If this is still unclear, the student can go to a Student Support Center where the tutors assist students with this or any other questions they might have. The labs are available for the students while the classes are in session for the student's convenience.

The Director ensures all instructors are certified to teach online in compliance with the College's requirements and that all instructors stay up-to-date with training requirements. In addition, instructors must send documentation of the requirement before being offered the course. These requirements help ensure instructors have current knowledge of state and national accessibility requirements and are aware of Title V guidelines for regular effective contact.

To ensure classes are consistently available to FIELD's instructors, FIELD staff developed "Introduction to Asynchronous Online Teaching" class, a 40-hour training program, which meets the aforementioned requirements.

In the previous four years classes were offered in various locations including Kern, Monterey, and Los Angeles counties. Classes were brought to students by holding classrooms in neighborhood community centers, schools, and churches.

The FIELD ISA bolsters and broadens the College's ability to serve underserved and a more diverse student body. This was particularly significant factor for the College in 2023-2024 as the COS-FIELD partnership served more students than another other program. Also, these ESL courses serve as an important pathway for FIELD as many of its students continue on to its high school (mentioned below) to pursue high school diplomas. Founded by Cesar Chavez in 1978, FIELD promotes economic and social prosperity for underserved communities through education, workforce training, and economic development. FIELD delivers its classes to economically disadvantaged adults over the age of 18 who are primarily Latino. According to FIELD, farmworkers' education averages at a 6th grade level and low literacy rates are high (as high as 21%).

Demographics

In the last four years, approximately 99% of FIELD students were Hispanic, which is the same ethnicity percentage as the previous four years. Less than 1% were Asian in the last four years.

Students by Ethnicity	Asian	Filipino	Hispanic	2 or More Races	Not Reported	White/Non-Hispanic
2020-2021	3		467	2	2	2
2021-2022	8	1	647	3	40	2
2022-2023			74			
2023-2024	3		571		7	1
Students by Ethnicity 2020-2024	**14**	**1**	**1759**	**5**	**49**	**5**

Gender

Generally, there are double the number of females in ESL classes to males. In the last 4 years, 73% of students were females and 27% were males.

By Gender	Female	Male	Unreported
2020-2021	354	120	2
2021-2022	517	183	1
2022-2023	57	15	2
2023-2024	402	170	10
Students by Gender 2020-2024	1330	488	15

Age Chart

ESL students have a significant percentage of older students. In the last 4 years, 82% of ESL students were age 30 or older. The largest age group — 27% — was ages 40 to 49. The smallest age group was ages 19 or younger at less than 2%.

Students By Age	19 or younger	20-24	25-29	30-34	35-39	40-49	50 +
2020-2021	7	23	26	50	77	137	156
2021-2022	16	48	71	113	112	196	145
2022-2023		2	7	10	11	18	26
2023-2024	10	57	68	74	69	145	159
Total Students by Age 2020-2024	**33**	**130**	**172**	**247**	**269**	**496**	**486**

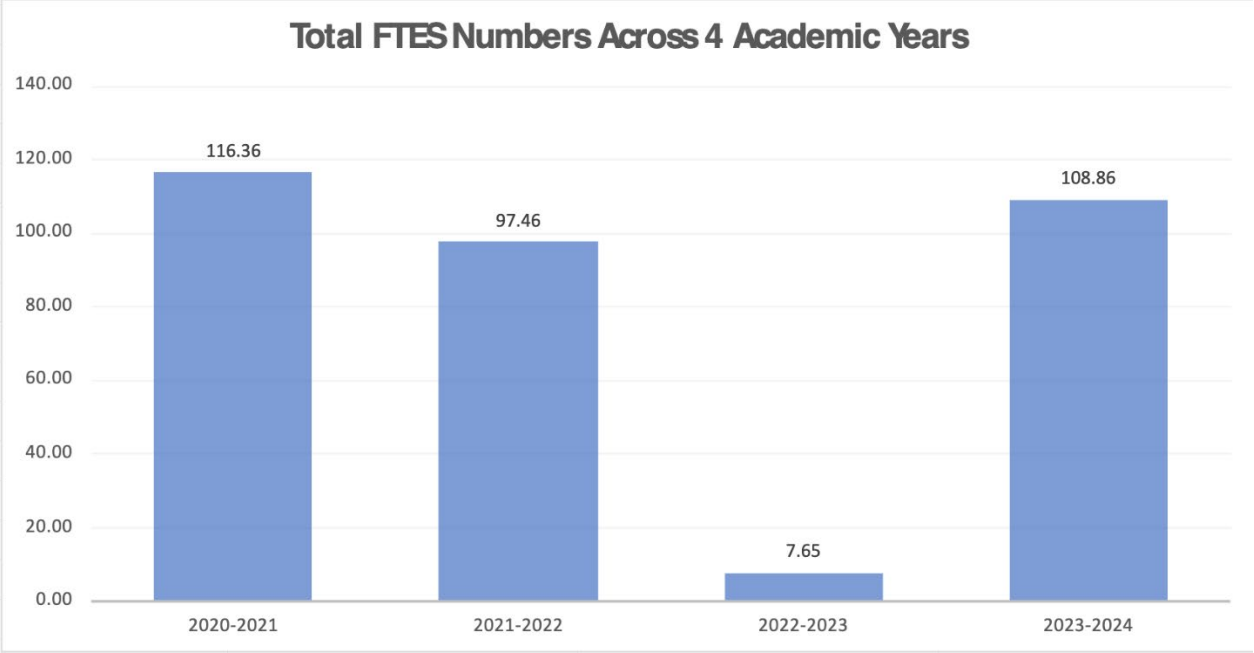
Number of Students Served

The 2023-2024 COS-FIELD partnership served the most significant population of students with the highest FTES percentage share of the College's total FTES. The 2023-2024 FTES were similar to 2020-2021 with the most drastic decline occurring from 2021-2022 to 2022-2023. This was due to FIELD halting ESL offerings for almost one year and in 2022-2023, there was only one 6-week session on ESL, which was the first online ESL course offered. Please see charts below for details. The second lowest enrollment in 2021-2022 was due to EPIC's

low enrollment as post-pandemic most students learned they preferred online learning for its flexibility, however the high school was limited to how much teaching could be offered online. This factor impacted the high school's enrollment and so FIELD decreased offerings, which eventually came to a halt in 2022-2023.

Enrollment by Year

Academic Year	Unduplicated Headcount	Duplicated Headcount	320 Report FTES Total
2020-2021	476	1013	116.36
2021-2022	701	1267	97.46
2022-2023	74	74	7.65
2023-2024	582	1570	108.86
Total	1603	3924	330.34



Enrollment by ESL Level

Academic Year	By ESL Level	Unduplicated Headcount	Duplicated Headcount
2020-2021	ESL 1	250	424
2020-2021	ESL 2	163	324
2020-2021	ESL 3	139	265
2020-2021	Sub Total	476	1013
2021-2022	ESL 1	553	847
2021-2022	ESL 2	202	295
2021-2022	ESL 3	74	125
2021-2022	Sub Total	701	1267
2022-2023	ESL 1	37	37
2022-2023	ESL 2	29	29
2022-2023	ESL 3	8	8
2022-2023	Sub Total	74	74
2023-2024	ESL 1	304	574
2023-2024	ESL 2	282	703
2023-2024	ESL 3	115	293
2023-2024	**Sub Total**	**582**	**1570**
Total	Total	1603	3924

(students can potentially enroll multiples times in the same course)

2. External Factors with Significant Impact:

Part-Time Faculty

All ESL faculty are the employees of FIELD. The College doesn't have any control over whether FIELD hires instructors full-time or part-time. Before FIELD started offering online classes, leaders indicated they intended to create some full-time teaching positions, however this has not happened. The Director believes it would be more productive and beneficial to the students to have at least one full-time instructor. A full-time instructor would help provide continuity and stability as FIELD would be more reluctant to cancel all classes with short notice.

Lack of Technology

Lack of computer access and stable internet is repeatedly relayed through SLO surveys is students' lack of computer access and stable internet access despite Student Support Centers. Lack of computer knowledge is an issue as well since all classes in 23-24 were online. In addition, many students have little experience using computers.

Student Education Levels

As FIELD recruits low-skilled workers — predominantly farmworkers — for its ESL classes, low-education levels and literacy rates are always in issue within the ESL student populations. This poses a unique set of challenges to ESL instructors, challenges that should always be factored in when developing new efforts.

Instructor Turnover

Due to budgetary constraints, FIELD pays its instructors less than the average Adult Education hourly wage so the pay is not competitive. Also, instructors are generally expected to work year round with significantly less breaks than a teacher or college instructor.

Attendance Accounting Method for Online Classes

Online classes require the Chancellor's Office census-based attendance accounting rather than tracking student attendance. This has posed challenges both for FIELD and College staff predominantly while enrolling students. As ESL classes have a very short duration – 6 weeks – the first census usually comes about 7 days after the class start dates. Currently, the College hand processes paper registrations each session, which can be very timely. The Director is working with Enrollment Services to help streamline the process and ensure FIELD submits registration forms in ample time for them to be processed by the first census. The hope is that the process will become smoother in 2025 both for the College and FIELD

3. Progress on Outcome Assessment:

Student Learning Outcome Surveys

The Director collects SLO surveys after each 6-week session using Microsoft Forms and stored digitally. This information is not on Elumen as was anticipated and projected in the 2020 Program Review. The data helps inform the Director how to better support ESL students and FIELD instructors.

CASAS Testing

The Director also collects the annual results of testing FIELD conducts in all its ESL classes called the Comprehensive Adult Student Assessment System (CASAS), which provides testing of basic and academic skills for youth and adults and curriculum tools to design instruction. Every new ESL student is given an appraisal test, and then a Pre-Test based on that appraisal. All students who have taken a pre-test and who have attended a minimum of 40 hours of instruction then take the post-test at the end of that session. This is repeated for every session. Once a student takes the initial pre-test, he or she then only takes the end of session post test from that time on regardless of how may

subsequent sessions the student attends. Below is the CASAS data for the last 4 years.

Program/Course or Instructional Improvements Based on Assessment: The Director works closely with FIELD staff to ensure quality online non-credit ESL and sufficient oversight by accessing course shells and instructor communications. In April 2023, the Director visited Student Support Centers to ensure students had ample access to computers and staff support.

Program Assessment Plan for Next 4 Years: The Director will continue to have instructors report SLOs after each session, which will continue to be collected and stored digitally. Annual CASAS testing data will continue to be collected. The Director consistently monitors the CASAS website for the 2023-2024 assessment outcomes and determined they likely won't be available until January 2025.

4. Qualitative Results: Course Completion & CASAS Assessments:

Course Completion Rates: Course completion rates in this section pertain the number of students who transition from one ESL level to the next level and the number of students who earned a Certificate of Completion. With only one full year of online ESL and 23-24 CASAS Assessment Data unavailable at this time, it is difficult to compare course completion rates from previous years in which classes were taught in-person. The Director will revisit this data once the 2023-2024 assessment outcomes are available through CASAS.

In 2023-2024, 23% of ESL students moved from ESL 1 to ESL 2 and 16% of students moved from ESL 2 to ESL 3.

2023-2024 ESL Enrollment	
	Enrollments
ESL 1	304
ESL 2	282
ESL 3	115

Student % Moving Up ESL Level	
	% of Students
To ESL 2	23%
To ESL 3	16%
ESL 1-ESL 3	5%

Completions from ESL 1, to ESL 2 to, ESL 3			
Starting Class	Enrollments	Students Continued to ESL 2	Students Continued to ESL 3
ESL 1	304	69	6

Completions from ESL 2 to ESL 3		
Starting Class	Enrollments	Students Continued to ESL 3
ESL 2	282	46

Comparison of Certificates Earned

In 2021-2022, 4% of students --- 28 out of 701 students --- completed all 3 ESL levels and earned Certificates of Completion. In 2023-2024, 3% of students -- 15 out of 582 students -- earned certificates.

	2020-2021	2021-2022	2022-2023*	2023-2024
Certificates of Completion	18	28	0	15

*No opportunity existed in 2022-2023 to earn a Certificate of Completion as there was only one session.

Discussion on Course Completion

With only one full year of online ESL and 23-24 CASAS Assessment Data unavailable at this time, it is difficult at this point to compare course completion rates from previous years in which classes were taught in-person. However, the Director analyzed the number of students moving to higher ESL levels and Certificates of Completion.

Number of students completing the sequence (ESL 1, 2 & 3)

In 2023-2024, approximately 3% of students completed all 3 ESL levels to earn a Certificate of Completion, which was a 1% decrease of certificates earned in 2021-2022 and 2020-2021. While the distinguishing difference between 2023-2024 and previous years are online classes, it is difficult to attribute to decrease to teaching mode. The Director will revisit this data once the 2023-2024 assessment outcomes are available on the CASAS website. CASAS date from previous years is cited below.

Course Completion Rate Goal

It is not in the Director's purview to set Course Completion Rate goals, however the Director consistently collaborates with FIELD to ensure program improvement. Unfortunately, the CASAS Assessment data for 2023-2024 won't be available until January 2025 so the Director is unable to compare outcomes for in-person classes to online classes.

Course Success Rate

To understand student success, the CASAS data is a far more meaningful data regarding course success as proficiency in English speaking and writing skills are assessed, which CASAS terms "Educational Functioning Level Completion Rates" which pertains to those students who attend more than 40 hours of

instruction within the online session and have taken a pre-test and post-test at session's end.

CASAS Educational Functioning Student Percentages

CASAS ESL ASSESSMENT OUTCOMES						
	Year	Beginning Low	Beginning High	Intermediate Low	Intermediate High	Low Advanced
CA State Goal	2023-2024	40		34.5	34.5	25
CA State Goal	2022-2023	30.5	34.5	30.5	31.5	21.5
CA State Average	2022-2023	50.5	48.5	39.9	39.4	24.4
FIELD	2020-2021	60	63.3	35.6	39.1	40
FIELD	2021-2022	20.8	48.7	34.5	27.3	36.7
FIELD	2022-2023	50	33.3	26.9	30	0
FIELD 2023-2024 Assments Outcomes available from CASAS in January 2025						

*The 2023-2024 CASAS assessment data is currently unavailable. Generally this data is available in January or February or each academic year. The Director consistently monitors the CASAS site for this information as eagerly awaits this specific year's data as is it the first full year offering online ESL.

5. Evaluation – Progress on Prior Goals:

Student Support Centers

During the launch of online ESL classes, the Director ensured FIELD established Student Support Centers to support ESL students and provide technological access required for online classes. FIELD Student Support Centers are places students go to get help with technological support provided by teaching assistants. With the understanding that most FIELD students have limited computer skills, teaching assistants can help with such tasks as logging into class. There are 10-15 laptops in each center. Most of the centers are at existing FIELD locations where its adult charter high schools, EPIC, are based.

Class Visitations

The Director visits online classes by accessing all Canvas course shells and finding opportunities to attend Zoom meetings. In April 2024, the Director visited Student Support Centers in Yuba City, Greenfield, Merced, Hollister, and Paso Robles, and met ESL Tutors and Site Coordinators.

Instructor Evaluations

The Director has ensured that instructor evaluations – peer, self, and student evaluations -- continued with the online teaching environment.

Syllabi

The Director will continue to ensure syllabi that that meet accreditation standards and confirms they are posted within all Canvas Course Shells.

6. Closing the Budget Loop: The FIELD budget is predominantly set to cover projected instruction reimbursement costs so this section is not very relevant. The Director did not submit any Resource Allocation Requests in the last budget cycle.

7. Vision:

This section is not technically applicable as the COS-FIELD ISA is not a "program." However, the Director plans to ensure all systems are in place to ensure student success and compliance with all Title 5 requirements pertaining to the ISA.

For this Vision section, the Director composed a "wish list" for the future of FIELD's ESL operations below. This Director believes this wish list will boost ESL learning outcomes overall and number of students earning the ESL Certificate of Completion.

Consistent ESL Offerings

In the last 4 years, FIELD has cancelled classes for several months and in 2022-2023 there was only one session. The impacts on students and instructors are significant as students lose their classes and instructors lose their jobs.

Chromebooks and Internet Access for All

Instructors consistently report on SLOs that lack of internet access and access to computers continues to be an issue despite Student Support Centers. Instructors also report that many students don't know how to use computers sufficiently.

One Full-Time Instructor

The Director believes it would be more productive and beneficial to the students to have at least one full-time instructor.

Launch Workplace English Online Class

The Director believes offering a "Workplace Readiness English" class would support upper-level ESL students, complement FIELD's adult charter high school, and benefit students' potential to obtain better jobs. More details about the class can be found in the section below.

8. Four-Year Action Plan:

In the next four years, the Director will continue to serve as a liaison between FIELD and the College to ensure compliance with Title 5 requirements. The Director will also continue to ensure quality online ESL classes for online classes. The Director will also help streamline the Registration process by creating a guide for FIELD staff and providing training on the Guide to FIELD staff.

To better serve students with higher ESL proficiency, the Director will encourage FIELD to start a class for students who earn the Certificate of Completion by offering Workplace Readiness English. WORK 0502: Workplace Readiness English is approved to be offered online. As the Course Outline states: "Students will, through the development of written communication skills, strengthen business vocabulary, learn proper sentence structure and correct spelling, proper use of pronouns, and gain knowledge of online office reference materials. These skills place an emphasis on job-specific skills in the workforce." The Director believes this class would support students and complement FIELD's adult charter high school.

The Director will also collaborate with FIELD to work on addressing two top concerns: lack of technological access and instructor turnover.

9. Conclusions:

The Director primarily attributes the program's weaknesses to low-education and literacy levels of students, instructor turnover, technological challenges, and the daily challenges students face in terms of work-home obligations. These weaknesses can be seen in low percentages of students moving from one ESL level to another and also earning Certificates of Completion.

While there are some inherent obstacles to serving ESL students, the Director is hopeful that program changes can be made to better serve students. Suggestions include hiring one-full time ESL instructor to ensure continuation of course offerings, better address technological challenges by providing students with more support and ensuring viable and accessible Student Support Centers.

The College's partnership with FIELD enables the college to serve a significantly more diverse student population and to reach an underserved population that it otherwise would likely not be able to reach. In 2023-2024, the College's partnership with FIELD served more students than any other program at the College. The relationship enables the College to better support equity populations, specifically Latino students. ESL is a vital bridge to FIELD's high school and also improves students' lives overall as it enables them to better navigate daily life. Ultimately the College's partnership with FIELD furthers COS' mission to transform students' lives through lifelong learning and success.